country of service delivery and consumption); and presence of natural persons (where the service provider physically moves to the country where the service is consumed).

The export of services in three modes—cross-border supply, consumption abroad and presence of natural persons—is included in the current account statistics. The service delivered by commercial presence does not form part of the current account statistics but is captured to measure the full extent of export of services. The data for export of services through commercial presence abroad is captured as part of the Foreign Affiliates Trade Statistics (FATS) generated by the World Trade Organization (WTO). WTO produces a report called ‘Trade in Services by Mode of Supply’ (TISMOS), which combines the current account statistics of export in services and FATS to produce a full account of the global trade in services.

India’s share of services in the basket of export of services in 2018 was the third highest among major exporters. Singapore, with about 31 per cent share of services, had the largest share of services in total exports, followed by the European Union (EU), which had a share of a little over 29 per cent. India had a share of about 28 per cent. The US, which has 80 per cent share of services in its GDP, had a share of export of services of 25 per cent in its total exports.

With services dominating global GDP today, exports reflect the developed state of the economy. Developed/advanced countries account for over two-third of global export of services, developing countries about 32 per cent, and least developed countries only 0.8 per cent.

According to data from the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD), global trade in services (excluding services delivered in commercial presence abroad) was $5.8 trillion in 2018. It increased at a lower rate of about 2.7 per cent in 2019 (over 7.5 per cent in the previous two years), rising to $6 trillion. The US was the largest